B1 Listening

Understanding a weather forecast

Catch the key facts in a radio weather forecast: places, times, temperatures and what the weather will do.

Weather forecasts are short and fast, but they always follow the same pattern: when, where, what the weather will be like, and the temperature. Know the key words and you can predict most of what you will hear.

Topic	Words you will hear
Times	*this morning, later today, overnight, by the weekend*
Sky and rain	*sunny, cloudy, showers, heavy rain, clear skies*
Wind and dust	*strong winds, a light breeze, dusty, sandstorm*
Temperature	*highs of 38, lows of 24, warmer, cooler, around 30 degrees*
Change	*clearing up, getting worse, dropping, rising*

Listen

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Good morning, and here's the weather for the next two days. This morning will be sunny in most areas, with highs of thirty-eight degrees in the capital. Later today, strong winds will bring dust to the north, so drivers should take care. Overnight, it will be clear and cooler, with lows of twenty-four. Tomorrow, clouds will move in from the sea, and there may be light showers on the coast in the afternoon. Temperatures will drop a little, to around thirty-four. By the weekend, things should be sunny and calm again.

Prepare a grid. Before you listen, draw three columns: *time, weather, temperature*. Fill in only numbers and key words while you listen.

Common mistake. Mixing up highs and lows. *Highs* are the daytime maximum; *lows* are the night-time minimum.

Practice

1. What will the weather be like this morning?
2. What is the highest temperature in the capital today?
3. Which area will have dust later today?
4. What is the lowest temperature tonight?
5. Where might it rain tomorrow, and when?
6. What will the weather be like at the weekend?

▼ **Show answers**

1. Sunny in most areas
2. 38 degrees
3. The north
4. 24 degrees
5. On the coast, in the afternoon
6. Sunny and calm